see for your app; the internal URL that IIS uses when forwarding requests is never exposed.

If you're not using IIS as a reverse proxy—maybe you're using NGINX or exposing your app directly to the internet—you may find you need to configure the URLs your application listens to directly.

By default, ASP.NET Core listens for requests on the URL http://localhost:5000. There are lots of ways to set this URL, but in this section I describe two: using environment variables or using command-line arguments. These are the two most common approaches I see (outside of IIS) for controlling which URLs your app uses.

TIP For further ways to set your application's URL, see my "5 ways to set the URLs for an ASP.NET Core app" blog post: http://mng.bz/go0v.

In chapter 10 you learned about configuration in ASP.NET Core, and in particular about the concept of hosting environments so that you can use different settings when running in development compared with production. You choose the hosting environment by setting an environment variable on your machine called `ASPNETCORE_ENVIRONMENT`. The ASP.NET Core framework magically picks up this variable when your app starts and uses it to set the hosting environment.

You can use a similar special environment variable to specify the URL that your app uses; this variable is called `ASPNETCORE_URLS`. When your app starts up, it looks for this value and uses it as the application's URL. By changing this value, you can change the default URL used by all ASP.NET Core apps on the machine. For example, you could set a temporary environment variable in Windows from the command window using

```
set ASPNETCORE_URLS=http://localhost:8000
```